



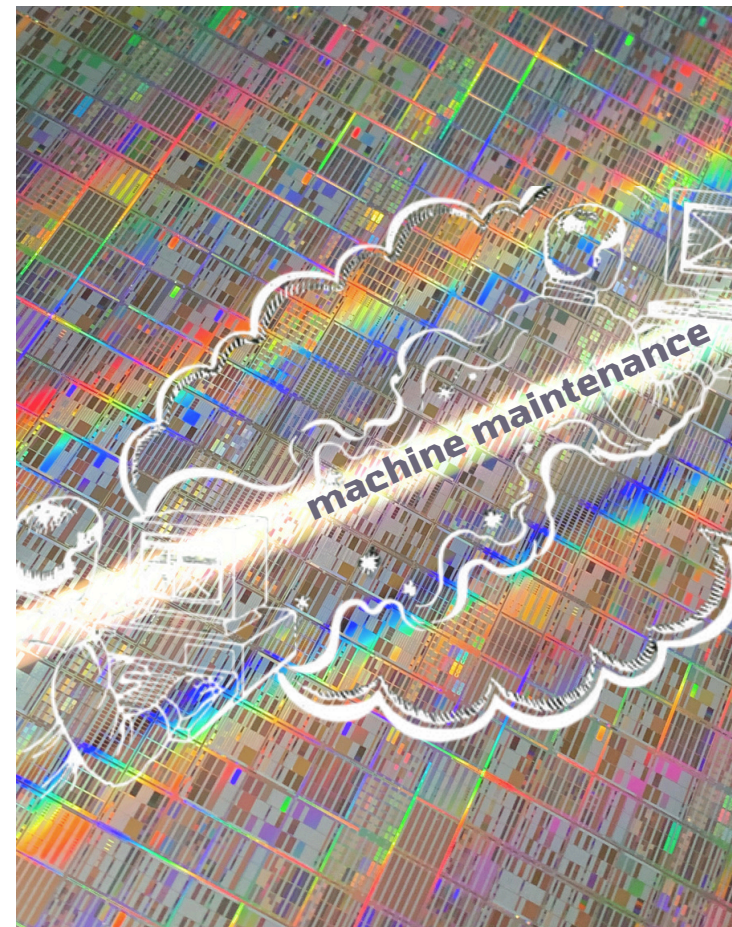
Jack Dorsey answers "Why the hell are you all spending so much time on bitcoin?"

3412 sats \ 35 comments \ @k00b 2 May 2024 bitcoin

This was in Block's Q1 Shareholder letter.

“But why spend time on bitcoin at all? We believe the world needs an open protocol for money, one that’s not owned or controlled by any single entity. We believe bitcoin is the best and only candidate to be that protocol, and to ultimately become the native currency of the internet.”

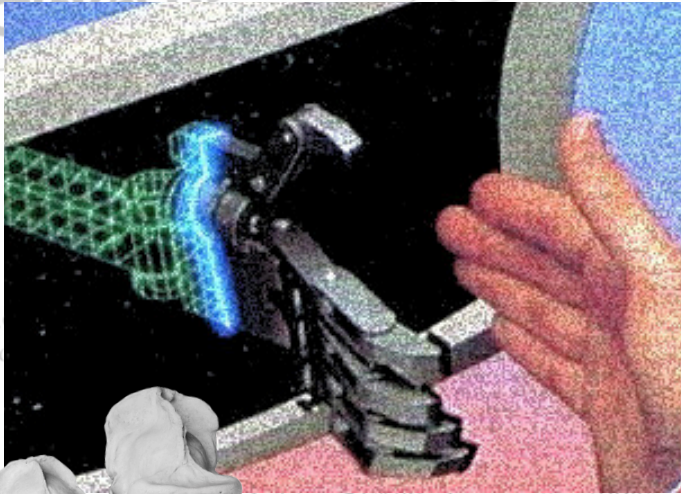
<https://stacker.news/items/527346>



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Apr 12 - Apr 18
ISSUE #4

Chapter 22 CRYPTOGRAPHIC GOTCHAS



Note from the Editor

Our way of being is changing.

Something new is emerging in the relationship between human and computer, man and machine.

You are looking for the person, the philosophy, the product, etc. that has the "right answer" regarding technology and the future, but you won't find that.

You will have to look inside yourself. If there is human in there, that voice will make itself known.

made in Austin by @plebpoet
supported by @k00b
quality assurance by @ek

Obvious innovation that people once feared

1893 sats \ 40 comments \ @birdeye21 19 Oct 2023 bitcoin

The internet was once just a passing fad...

...What is it about technology that frightens so many people?

442 sats \ 8 replies \ @k00b 19 Oct 2023

Not all change carries risk but all risk carries change. I think evolution has installed this "change is risky" heuristic in us.

48 sats \ 1 reply \ @k00b 19 Oct 2023

You can almost measure how much change a technology will cause by the severity of people's fears around it.

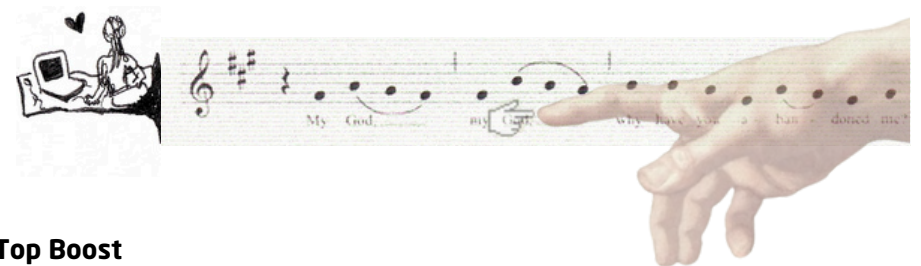
How does it feel when bots zap your posts? 🤖⚡

3251 sats \ 36 comments \ @Scoresby 21 Mar 2024 meta

SN introduced social media intertwined with sats--something completely new as far as I know. Zaps provide signal, return value to thoughtful posters and commenters, and likely prevent spam.

But SN isn't just about the zaps. There is a community here and we enjoy each other's company...or least we enjoy yammering back and forth at each other. Using SN isn't just a commercial interaction.

@k00b and crew have done an incredible job navigating the difference between commercial interaction and social interaction--creating a use case for money that is completely novel. I don't think social media will ever be the same. I wonder if money will.

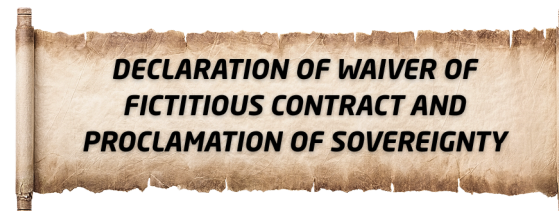


Top Boost

The 1st step into your sovereignty is to declare it

2421 sats \ 10k boost \ 13 comments \ @DarthCoin 14 Apr Politics_And_Law

"I do not consent to being treated as a legal fiction. I request that you refrain from any action against me without proof of legitimate jurisdiction and informed consent."



Opinions on AI generated stuff

947 sats \ 30 comments \ @TheWildHustle 11 Apr AskSN

What are your opinions on

- Vibe Coding
- AI generated Art
- AI generated Songs

Just wanted to get a heat check.

I'm generally bullish on all of the above, but it seems like I'm in the minority. Shake some sense into me, SN.

814 sats \ 2 replies \ @mtk4000 11 Apr freebie

Art is the idea, craft is the execution. Anyone can learn to paint the Mona Lisa. That makes you skilled at a craft, but that doesn't make you an artist. I'm bullish on AI making it significantly easier for artists to bring ideas to fruition. The downside is the endless avalanche of AI slop. I think we'll survive it though.

21 sats \ 0 replies \ @OT 11 Apr

I'm still coming to terms with it. Music tech for the last 50 years or so has eaten the previous popular music. A few years ago you can press a button on your computer and an orchestra will play music. Now we might not even have to press the button.

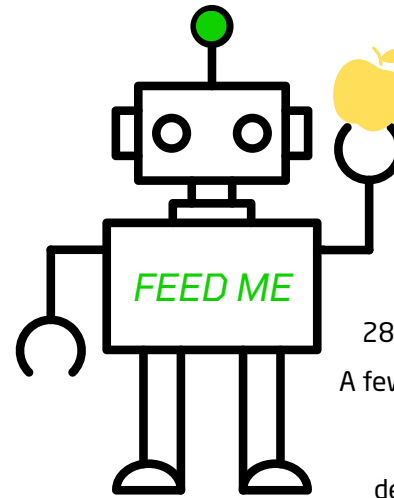
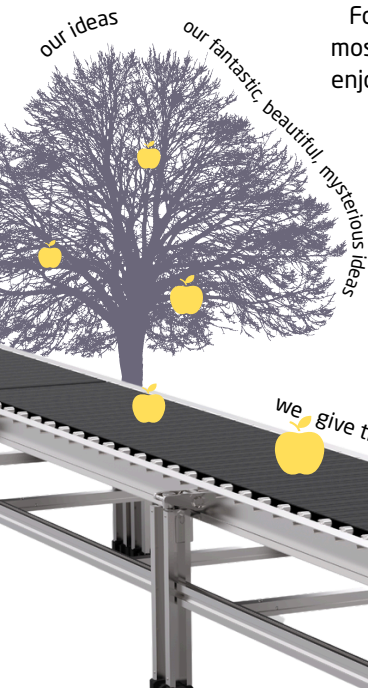
21 sats \ 1 reply \ @k00b 11 Apr

For art, where I'm not consuming something out of utility, I mostly enjoy thinking about the human in the loop - how I'm enjoying/consuming something that took them days/weeks/months to make, a lifetime of experience and skill before that, and an abundance of luck to be born with the talent. Even when AI art/music gets competitive with humans, and humans stop doing it, I'll probably think/judge based on the prompts more than the machine process that made it.

0 sats \ 0 replies \ @Undisciplined 11 Apr

Let reality sort it out: the code will either work well or it won't, people will either like the art or they won't. It doesn't fundamentally change anything from the status quo.

we give them to the robot



Someone Tried To Scam Me On RoboSats

2810 sats \ 43 comments \ @Jon_Hodl 13 Apr bitcoin

A few days ago, I was trying to stack some private sats on RoboSats with an Amazon gift card.

As soon as someone took my offer, I filled out the details of my lightning invoice and entered the chat.

I sent several messages and got no response. The seller had the green light on their robot to indicate that they were online so it was a bit odd to me.

I thought maybe it was a Tor connectivity issue but I continued to send several more messages in hopes of making the trade.

After like 30 mins of no response, I opted for a collaborative cancel. Only just a couple minutes after I initiated the collab cancel, the seller starts to respond in the chat saying "Hey sorry. I'm here and ready for the code when you are."

I could instantly tell this was a scam.

They were obviously trying to get me to send the code after I had already initiated the collab cancel so that they could just cancel the transaction as soon as I sent the code.

Luckily, this wasn't my first rodeo so I avoided losing any money.

I told the scammer that it's too late and they would have to cancel and try again with a new order.

If you're an RoboSats user, absolutely NEVER send any money after you have initiated a collaborative cancel.

Stay safe out there, plebs.

204 sats \ 4 replies \ @siggy47 13 Apr

Lately I have frequently encountered a long delay after a seller accepts my gift card offer. Sometimes the seller is online, sometimes not. It's not unusual to wait 3 hours. Odd behavior. I never exercised a collaborative cancel, and eventually the transactions go through. Maybe it's the same guy waiting for someone using a gift card to initiate a cancel, or maybe it's innocent. I don't know.

63 sats \ 3 replies \ @TheBTCManual 13 Apr

All robosats traders I've worked with have been a delight, because I make it very clear you F me on a deal, I take your bond and your wife, simple as!

11 sats \ 1 reply \ @hgw39 13 Apr

Are you on the premium version? I don't see the option to take the seller's wife on my interface? Would change the incentives a little so I'd like to find out more.

Why do you stack? - a hypothetical

1310 sats \ 41 comments \ @Public_N_M_E 11 Apr AskSN

Hello Stackers,

I was conversing with my wife over dinner and she asked me, "why do you stack?" and when it really boiled down to it my answer was

**"I don't know, because I don't like how it is
and I hope for a different way."**

Some context, we don't have kids, we may not ever have them.

So who are you leaving your legacy to? On the suggestion that BTC won't be mass adopted in our lifetime and BTC is for us to leave to our next generation... Why do you stack?

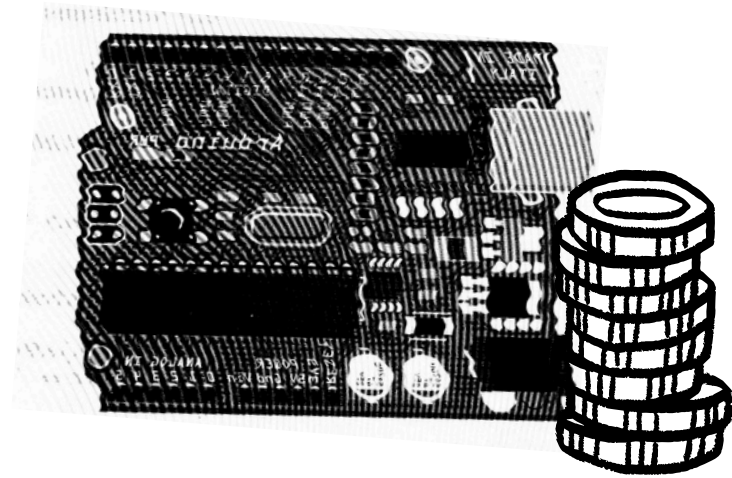
And a broader question, why do you invest in anything at all?

Appreciate your comments.

Pub 🍷

238 sats \ 4 replies \ @grayruby 11 Apr

I don't like my time and energy stolen by those that operate or sit next to the money printer and to hopefully leave the world a better, more fairer place for my kids.



31 sats \ 1 reply \ @tip_nz 12 Apr

Sats are a tool to shape your current reality and future world you wish to live in. I save in sats so they grow in value. Then I spend those sats to support the things I like and the people building the things I wish to exist in the world.

128 sats \ 1 reply \ @aljazz 11 Apr

the rebellion always needs funding.

21 sats \ 1 reply \ @Solomonsatoshi 12 Apr

Soon as I heard about bitcoin (2017) i stacked...to hold my wealth directly.

Now 8 years later am semi-retired living 100% on those stacked sats.

Did not think/expect it could happen but it did.

Just wanted autonomy from rentseeking fiat debt slavery usury.

cheers Satoshi.

Fuck the banks and the governments that they own - pretty much all of them.

Only stack if you want to be part of the peaceful revolution to create an alternative to the fiat debt slavery bankers cartel that (almost certainly) owns your government..



21 sats \ 1 reply \ @LibertasBR 11 Apr

I stack because I love the project and everything it's built on that makes it what it is. On top of that, it gives me something that's truly mine, gives me sovereignty, and pushes me to seek more knowledge. I think it's almost cliché at this point. And I'll add that I'm also looking for stability for my virtual wealth.

0 sats \ 0 replies \ @Public_N_M_E OP 12 Apr

Yeah, I respect that. Sovereignty is something I think we all handed over under the guise of protection and ease... I'd like mine back.

Who pays for Bitcoin wallets?

19.5k sats \ 46 comments \ @Scoresby 16 Apr bitcoin

I've recently been thinking about all the free Bitcoin software I use and why I am generally not willing to pay for software even though I am willing to entrust it with my life savings. Free open source software is the standard in the Bitcoin ecosystem, but it does create a bit of cognitive dissonance:

- 📦 Free open source software is better/safer/more secure
- 🌐 Free markets are more efficient, produce better products



Relying on people working for free is rarely as effective as paying people for their work. So why don't we pay for wallet software?



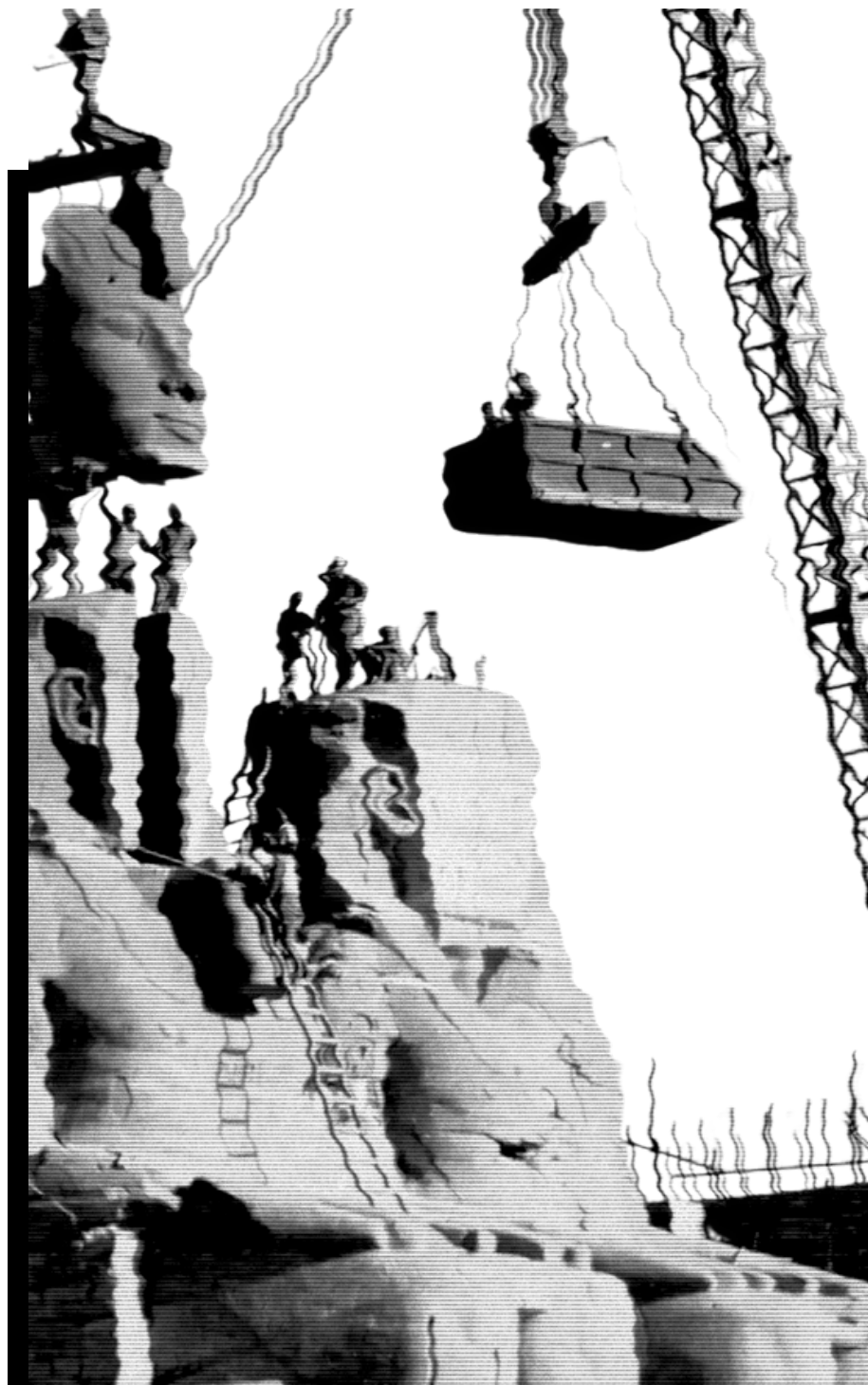
Software is a relationship

In a perfect world, you connect your Bitcoin wallet with your own node so you don't need to rely on wallet developers (or anyone else) to provide you with information about your coins or incoming transactions.

Your relationship with the wallet developers begins and ends when you download their wallet software. You don't need them to run a server for you and you have full access to all the wallet's features.

But even in this world, dependencies get outdated and vulnerabilities are discovered -- so you probably need the developers to patch your wallet software with some regularity. And then the Bitcoin protocol itself changes -- perhaps you'd like a wallet that takes advantage of some new feature (or maybe your wallet is no longer able to understand the coins other people send to it).

Now, we don't believe other people should be required to share their work with us for free. So what do you do if the developers of your wallet don't offer a patch for a critical vulnerability or don't release a new version to take advantage of the latest features in Bitcoin? Well, you probably go find a new wallet that is offering such things. But that is really just the same problem: you're looking for someone to do something for you for free.



How could you pay for a Bitcoin wallet if you wanted to?

Here is a comparison of all the Bitcoin-only (mostly), onchain wallet software I could think of and how I believe they fund themselves:

Wallet	Open Source	Custodial	Rev Model	Price
Bitcoin Core	✓	✗	Grants	Free
Sparrow	✓	✗	Donation	Free
Electrum	✓	✗	Donation	Free
Specter	✓	✗	Swan	Free
Blue Wallet	✓	✗	Unknown	Free
Schildbach	✓	✗	Donation	Free
Proton	✓	✗	ProtonMail	Free
Bitcoin Safe	✓	✗	Grants	Free
Liana	✓	✗	Partners	Free
Wasabi	✓	✗	Coinjoin fees	Varies
Ahigaru	✓	✗	Coinjoin fees	Varies
Nunchuk	✓	✗	Subscription	\$120-\$480/year
Keeper	✓	✗	Subscription	\$100-\$240/year
Theya	✗	✗	Subscription	\$250/yr
Green	✓	✗	Blockstream	Free
Envoy	✓	✗	Device sales	Free
Bitkey	✓	✗	Device Sales	\$150
Casa	✗	✗	Subscription	\$250-\$2100/yr
AnchorWatch	✗	✗	Subscription	.25%/yr
Unchained	✗	✗	Subscription	\$250/yr
River	✗	✓	Fees, spread	% of txs
Swan	✗	✓	Subscription	\$240-\$5000/yr
OnRamp	✗	✓	Subscription	\$3600-0.66%/yr

It's better to be a customer

When you must rely on a stranger to do something for you, it usually works out better if you are a customer. While the current--somewhat idealistic--attitude in Bitcoin software development is wonderful, it makes me wonder what will happen if all the venture money dries up. What if investors decide that funding Bitcoin wallet development is charity work with no ROI? How many of the currently available wallets would cease to be maintained? And, would this mean wallets can only exist on good will?

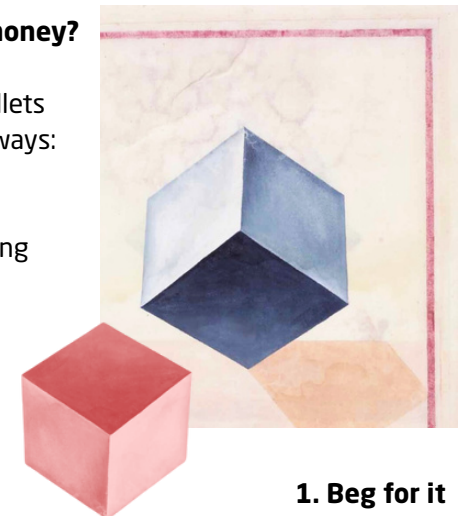
In the case of wallet software, most of us aren't capable to auditing it on our own, much less building and maintaining it. When you pay for a product or service, at least some expectations have been set out. If a person charges a price for a product, you can make a pretty good decision about whether it's worth it to you and you can assume that they are making enough out of the deal to be worth it. But if you are given a product and it becomes an integral part of your life and the the people who make it suddenly tell you that they are going broke and they can't keep it up anymore...you are in a tight spot.

It would be better if the developers of the best Bitcoin Wallets could win in the market and make a huge pile of money.

So: how do Bitcoin wallets make money?

Based on the above table, Bitcoin wallets make money in one of the following ways:

1. Beg for it
2. Do the freemium/subscription thing
3. Sell a device
4. Be a custodian
5. Take a commission
6. Be a layer 2
7. Sell the software



1. Beg for it

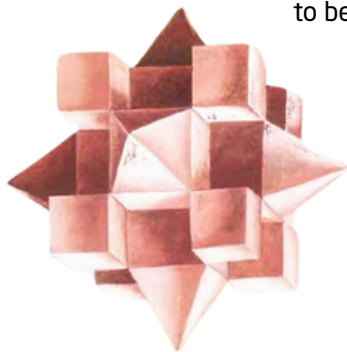
I'll admit I'm putting it harshly, but this is how the biggest wallets in Bitcoin support themselves: they ask companies or users to donate money to them through grants or patronage. It seems to be working for a number of important projects, so who am I to judge? But it doesn't seem like a very sustainable model to me (although, some pretty hefty religious institutions have been built on a similar model + guilt).

2. Do the Freemium/subscription thing

This is the model most of the wallets that have an eye on making money seem to be moving towards. Offer the basic wallet for free, but put a (somewhat random) collection of features behind a paid gate. Often the paid features involve interaction with the wallet developers (a cosigning key, cloud backups, etc.).

I suppose if we all don't mind paying for utilities like water, electricity, and internet access on a subscription/usage basis, why would we mind paying for our wallet software this way?

But it doesn't feel quite right to me: this is freedom money. I'm supposed to be able to hold it without needing to rely on a third party. If I use a wallet that requires me to pay every month, it sure starts to feel like I'm trusting a third party to be able to access my bitcoin.



3. Sell a device

Selling a hardware signing device naturally goes well with developing and maintaining wallet software. Devices each have their nuances, so a wallet that is made by the same company as your device has a lot of perks; although, perhaps they aren't worth it if you are worried about putting all your eggs in one basket.

Using different vendors for different parts of your setup is a pretty standard security practice.

Honestly, though, using the sales of a device to support wallet software development seems like one of the best models that we have.

4. Be a custodian

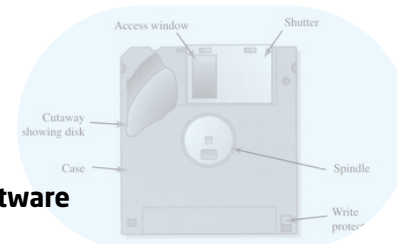
Custodians are natural choices for developing wallet software, too: you have to put it somewhere when you buy it. But exchanges are the most regulated and heavily monitored players in Bitcoin. If we expect being an exchange to be the revenue model for wallet software, we are opening ourselves up to regulatory scrutiny. You might as well have it be taxpayer-funded and get your government to develop wallet software...no thanks.

5. Take a commission

Wallet software developers could have deals with exchanges where they take a commission on in-app Bitcoin trades. Several wallets do use this method, and a good number of the shitcoin wallets seem to be making a good portion of their revenue this way. The downsides I can see are that it ties the wallet to a particular exchange and it's hard to see how Mr KYC won't be knocking on the devs' door in the near future.

6. Be a layer 2

Taking a cut of Lightning or some other Layer 2 action does make sense. There certainly are a lot of wallets that are trying this out (Zeus, Pheonix, Breez, Blitz, Zebedee, etc..). I didn't include any of them in the above table because none of them have a really great solution for the cold storage situation (at least that I'm aware). All the layer 2s on Bitcoin require hot keys, and that's not exactly the same kind of wallet you want to trust with your life savings.



7. Just sell your software

This is the option nobody ever talks about--and certainly none of the wallets out there are pursuing. I'm sure it's because minds wiser than mine have figured out that people don't want to pay for software. Most of the software world in general has abandoned outright purchasing software as a relic of the '90s. On that note, I still get a little rush when I think of bringing home a cardboard box with a little manual and cd for a new game in it. Man, those were the days!

Is it a problem?

The ecosystem is growing; there are new wallets and the wallets that exist are getting better. It certainly doesn't seem like there is a lack of funding or opportunity. So perhaps my ignorance is showing and I'm running around like Chicken Little here.

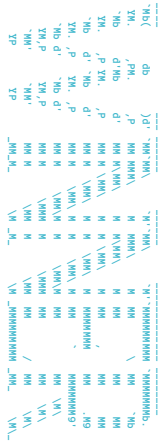
I'm curious for the Stackers' opinions: **what is a sustainable model for onchain Bitcoin wallet software development?**

Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

473 sats \ 19 comments \ @sn 14 Apr memes bot



5063 sats \ 2 replies \ @hasherstacker 14 Apr



SN Sunday Riddle

568 sats \ 6 comments \ @unschooled 13 Apr meta

Are you enjoying this meta, Stackers?

Previous weeks you have guessed swiftly and accurately, so I've made an effort to increase the difficulty (and, proportionally, the stakes too.)

Have at it:

I am not much – and that's to say –
Not much to those whose wealth today
Is stored by means thermodynamically sound
With which no state can be messing around.

A death-contract payment, of no small sum missed,
Has market players all clenching their fists.
Though I am not big news, at least in real terms,
Since all fiat debt be inflated or burned,

Hedge no bets 'gainst my macabre market signal.
An American dream or a swans' belching hymnal?

1,500 sats bounty



rleed

16 commits 1,840 ++ 905 --

#6

Shout out to contributors!
Thanks, y'all!

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0 sats \ 0 replies \ @Kontext 16 Apr
“The eye through which I see God is the same eye through which God sees me;
my eye and God’s eye are one eye,
one seeing,
one knowing,
one love.”
— Meister Eckhart

69 sats \ 0 replies \ @mo 13h



0 sats \ 1 reply \ @w4rrior 3h
When, by coincidence, your taste overlaps with fashion, fashion will move on and all the fashionistas with it.

0 sats \ 0 replies \ @applepie 4h
can i print this

